FixMyKasi: What Our App Does

Team brief for our first meeting, 9 November 2026

What FixMyKasi is

FixMyKasi lets residents report a community fault in a few taps, then follow it until it is properly fixed.

Today, many residents do not know where to report a problem. Reports get lost between call centres, WhatsApp groups and councillors, and neighbours report the same fault again and again. Once a report is made, people are left guessing.

FixMyKasi gives every fault one public record. Anyone can see what was reported, who is responsible, when it should be fixed and whether the work was really done.

Where reports go

Reports go to the municipality, because the municipality is responsible for fixing faults. The ward councillor can see what is happening in the ward and is alerted when a fault is overdue.

This matches how local government works: ward councillors escalate complaints but do not fix faults themselves. They also monitor complaints and give residents feedback.

Who	What they do in the app
Resident	Reports faults, upvotes existing reports, tracks progress and confirms the fix
Ward admin (municipal staff)	Checks new reports, removes duplicates, assigns the work and sets the due date
Municipal team	Updates progress and uploads a photo when the work is done
Contractor	Does the same as a municipal team when a job is outsourced
Ward councillor	Views the ward dashboard and receives overdue alerts

How a report moves:

1. A resident submits a fault and receives a reference number.
2. The app sends it to the correct ward admin based on the ward.
3. The ward admin checks it and assigns it to the right team or contractor.
4. The team fixes the fault and uploads an after photo.
5. The resident confirms the fix, or reopens the report if the problem is still there.
6. If the due date passes, the app flags the fault as overdue and alerts the ward councillor.

For this project, we have no official link to a municipality. Test accounts will play the municipal staff, teams and contractors. The ward admin can also record the municipality's own reference number on the report.

Area covered

FixMyKasi is organised ward by ward, so it can start with one municipality and grow to others without being rebuilt.

- **Project demo:** one municipality with three sample wards. We suggest the City of Johannesburg.
- **After the project:** every ward in that municipality.
- **Long term:** other municipalities across South Africa.

Each ward admin manages only their own ward. The public can view faults across all wards.

What a resident sends

A report includes a photo, the location and a short description, because each one answers a different question for the repair team.

Part of the report	Details	Why it matters
Category	Chosen from the list below	Sends the report to the right team
Photo	Up to 3 photos	Proves the fault exists and shows how serious it is
Location	Phone GPS, ward, street address and a nearby landmark	Helps teams find places where street numbers are unclear
Description	What is happening and when it started	Gives the team the details a photo cannot show
Urgency	Tick if it is dangerous	Moves it to the top of the ward admin's list

Before a report is submitted, the app shows similar reports nearby. The resident can upvote one of those instead of creating a duplicate.

The public list never shows the reporter's name or contact details.

What can be reported

FixMyKasi covers six groups of public faults, and each group goes to a specific team.

Category	Faults residents can report	Team responsible	Johannesburg example
Roads	Potholes, sinkholes, broken traffic lights, damaged or missing road signs, faded road markings, blocked stormwater drains, missing drain covers	Roads team	Johannesburg Roads Agency
Clean water	Burst clean water pipes, leaking pipes, leaking fire hydrants, no water, low water pressure, dirty water	Water team	Johannesburg Water
Sewer	Burst sewer pipes, blocked manholes, overflowing manholes, missing manhole covers, sewage running in the street	Sewer team	Johannesburg Water
Electricity	Faulty streetlights, faulty high-mast lights, power outages, open electricity boxes, fallen or exposed wires, damaged poles, cable theft, illegal connections	Electricity or streetlight team	City Power
Waste	Missed refuse collection, illegal dumping, overflowing public bins, dead animals on public land	Waste team	Pikitup
Public spaces	Overgrown parks and verges, fallen trees, broken park equipment, damaged public taps or toilets	Parks or facilities team	City Parks and Zoo

Marked urgent automatically: fallen or exposed wires, missing manhole or drain covers, major pipe bursts and broken traffic lights at busy intersections.

The app will remind residents to phone emergency services when someone's life is in immediate danger. It only accepts faults on public property.

Languages

Residents can use FixMyKasi in the language they are most comfortable with, while municipal staff can still understand every report.

- **Project version:** English, Afrikaans, isiZulu and Sepedi.
- **Later versions:** isiXhosa, Setswana, Sesotho, Xitsonga, siSwati, Tshivenda and isiNdebele.
- **Translated reports:** AI translates a resident's description into English for the ward admin and keeps the original wording beside it.
- **Accessibility:** large icons, simple words and voice notes are planned for later versions. South African Sign Language video support can follow.

Progress and accountability

Every fault moves through seven clear statuses, and each change is saved with a date and time.

Status	What it means	What the resident sees
Received	The report has been logged	Reference number and date reported
Viewed	The ward admin has opened it	Date viewed
Assigned	A team or contractor is responsible	Department, team and contractor name, if outsourced
Scheduled	The work has been planned	Expected fix date and estimated time to fix
In progress	The team is working on it	Start date and latest update
Fixed	The team says the work is done	After photo and actual completion date
Closed	The resident has confirmed the fix	Total time taken

Three extra labels handle problems:

- **Delayed:** the team gives a reason and a new date.
- **Overdue:** the app adds this automatically when the due date passes, then alerts the ward councillor.
- **Reopened:** the resident says the fault is not fixed, and it returns to the ward admin.

If a resident does not respond after 7 days, a fixed fault closes automatically.

Example of what a resident sees (sample data):

Detail	Example
Reference number	FMK-2026-00123
Fault	Burst clean water pipe, Vilakazi Street
Status	Scheduled
Assigned department	Water team
Done by	Outsourced contractor
Contractor name	Sample Plumbing Services (Pty) Ltd
Expected fix date	18 November 2026
Estimated time to fix	2 days
Neighbours affected	14 upvotes
Latest update	Parts ordered and crew booked

The public can see the team or contractor company name. Individual workers' names and phone numbers stay visible only to the ward admin.

What makes it a winning app

FixMyKasi must win on accountability, because reporting apps already exist in South Africa.

Municipalities have their own channels, such as My Ekurhuleni and the eThekwini app. CityMenderSA already offers public, geotagged tracking of service delivery faults.

Our pitch is that reporting a fault is only the start. FixMyKasi tracks who owns the job until the resident agrees it is fixed:

- **Named responsibility:** every fault shows the team or contractor company responsible.
- **A promised date:** every assigned fault has an expected fix date and an estimated time to fix.
- **Automatic escalation:** overdue faults alert the ward councillor.
- **Proof of work:** teams upload after photos.
- **The resident has the final say:** a fault is not successfully closed if the resident reopens it.
- **Ward performance data:** the dashboard shows open faults, overdue faults and average time to fix.

What we build for this project

We keep to five Must features, as the brief asks for 3 to 5, and add the rest only once those work on the live link.

Priority	Feature	Includes
Must 1	Report a fault	Login, category, photo, location, description, reference number and four interface languages
Must 2	Public fault list	Search by ward and category, upvotes and nearby similar reports
Must 3	Assign the work	Ward admin chooses the team or contractor, due date and estimated time to fix
Must 4	Track progress	All seven statuses, full history and resident confirmation or reopening
Must 5	Ward dashboard	Open faults, overdue faults and average time to fix
Should 1	Proof of work	After photos from the team
Should 2	AI help	Suggested category and urgency, and translated descriptions
Should 3	Map view	Faults shown as pins coloured by status
Should 4	Ward councillor view	View-only dashboard and overdue alerts

Questions for the team:

- Do we agree on the City of Johannesburg for the demo?
- Is a photo compulsory, or can a resident submit without one if it is unsafe to take a picture?
- Are English, Afrikaans, isiZulu and Sepedi the right four languages for the first version?

Sources

SAnews: From service delivery to the ballot box | eNCA: What your ward councillor can and can't do | Fourways Review: where to report service delivery issues | CRA: How to log service issues in Johannesburg | Benoni City Times: My Ekurhuleni app | IOL: Durban fault reporting channels | Daily Maverick: CityMenderSA